Alderpoint Health Plan - Medical Policy

Policy MP-HH-007 | Home Health Services | Effective 01/01/2026

1. Purpose

This policy describes when Alderpoint Health Plan covers skilled home health services.

2. Definitions

Homebound: leaving home requires a considerable and taxing effort, and the member needs the help of another person or a supportive device to leave home. Absences for medical care do not by themselves change homebound status.

Skilled service: a service that requires the skills of a registered nurse or a licensed therapist to be delivered safely and effectively.

Facility-based alternative: admission to a skilled nursing facility or an inpatient rehabilitation facility.

3. Coverage criteria

3.1 Standard criteria. Home health services are medically necessary when all of the following are met:

(a) A physician ordered the services under a written plan of care after a face-to-face encounter related to the reason for home health.

(b) The member needs intermittent skilled nursing or skilled therapy services.

(c) The treating practitioner certified in the record that the member is homebound, with a statement of the clinical findings that support homebound status.

3.2 Visit limits. Up to 60 visits per benefit year across all disciplines. Additional visits require a new review.

3.3 Home-based care in place of a facility admission. Home health services ordered in place of a facility-based alternative are medically necessary, without certification of homebound status under 3.1(c), when all of the following are documented:

(a) The member meets Plan criteria for admission to a skilled nursing facility or an inpatient rehabilitation facility, as documented by the treating physician or a case manager.

(b) The home setting was evaluated and found clinically appropriate and safe for the ordered services, including caregiver availability when a caregiver is needed.

(c) The expected cost of the home health services does not exceed the expected cost of the facility-based alternative.

4. Documentation

Acceptable documentation includes the plan of care, the face-to-face encounter note, therapy evaluations, case management and discharge planning notes, and home safety evaluations.

5. Not covered

Custodial care, homemaker services, and services that a caregiver without clinical training can provide safely.

6. Review of this policy

This policy is reviewed annually. The version in force on the date of the determination applies.